

## EDUCATION

### Doctor of Philosophy

Expected In July 2028

The University of Sydney

Adviser: Associate Professor Anusha Withana

Department: Computer Science (Human Computer Interaction)

### Bachelor of Advanced Computing (Honours)

2019 - 2024

The University of Sydney

Honours Class I

Honours Subject Area: Human Computer Interaction

Major: Information Systems (Engineering)

### Bachelor of Commerce

2019 - 2024

The University of Sydney

Major: Business Information Systems

## PUBLICATIONS

**Yihao Dong**, Praneeth Bimsara Perera, Chin-Teng Lin, Craig T Jin, and Anusha Withana. 2026. TactDeform: Finger Pad Deformation Inspired Spatial Tactile Feedback for Virtual Geometry Exploration. In *Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '26)*, April 13–17, 2026, Barcelona, Spain. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 16 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3772318.3791699>

**Yihao Dong**, Pamuditha Somarathne, Craig Jin, Juno Kim, Andrea Bianchi, and Anusha Withana. 2025. Just Before Touch: Manipulating Perceived Haptic Sensations through Proactive Vibrotactile Cues in Virtual Reality. In *Proceedings of Augmented Humans International Conference (AHs '25)*. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 13 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3745900.3746097>

Hongyu Zhou, Chia-An Fan, **Yihao Dong**, Shuto Takashita, Masahiko Inami, Zhanna Sarsenbayeva, and Anusha Withana. 2026. SRL Proxemics: Spatial Guidelines for Supernumerary Robotic Limbs in Near-Body Interactions. In *Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '26)*, April 13–17, 2026, Barcelona, Spain. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 22 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3772318.3790532>

Hongyu Zhou, Tom Kip, **Yihao Dong**, Andrea Bianchi, Zhanna Sarsenbayeva, and Anusha Withana. 2025. Juggling Extra Limbs: Identifying Control Strategies for Supernumerary Multi-Arms in Virtual Reality. In *Proceedings of the 2025CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '25)*, April 26–May 01, 2025, Yokohama, Japan. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 16 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3706598.3713647> **[Honorable Mention – Top 5%]**

Hongyu Zhou, **Yihao Dong**, Masahiko Inami, Zhanna Sarsenbayeva, and Anusha Withana. 2025. A Survey on Methodological Approaches to Collaborative Embodiment in Virtual Reality. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2507.18877* (July 2025).  
<https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2507.18877>

## EXPERIENCES

### Associate Lecturer (PhD Teaching Fellow)

Oct 2025 - Present

The University of Sydney, Sydney, NSW

- Co-coordinate *COMP9001 Introduction to Programming*: Deliver foundational programming concepts using Python for a postgraduate-level cohort.
- Co-coordinate *COMP9123 Data Structures and Algorithms*: Instruct postgraduate students on core algorithmic paradigms, focusing on computational efficiency and optimized problem-solving strategies.

### Casual Academic

June 2023 - Present

The University of Sydney, Sydney, NSW

#### Honours Project Examiner

- INFO4999 Computer Science Honours S2, 2025 S2 2024

#### TA (Head Tutor)

- COMP5427 Usability Engineering S1 2025
- INFO3315 Human-Computer Interaction S2 2025

#### Tutor

- ISYS2120 Data and Information Management S2 2023, S2 2024
- COMP5338 Advanced Data Models S2 2024
- INFO3315 Human-Computer Interaction S1 2025, S2 2024

## VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

#### Guest Lecturer:

Usability Engineering (Postgraduate Course) 2026  
Human-Computer Interaction (Undergraduate Course) 2025

The University of Sydney

#### Peer-Reviewing:

External Reviewer CHI 2026, ISMAR 2026

#### Conferences and Symposia:

Student Volunteer AHs 2025

## AWARDS

|                                                                                                                 |             |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| <b>Honorable Mention Award</b><br>Zhou et al., CHI 2025 (Top 5% of submissions)                                 | 2025        |
| <b>Best Early PhD Project</b> , School of Computer Science Research Showcase<br><i>The University of Sydney</i> | 2025        |
| <b>Faculty of Engineering Research Scholarship</b><br><i>The University of Sydney</i>                           | 2024 - 2028 |
| <b>Undergraduate High Honour Roll</b> , School of Computer Science<br><i>The University of Sydney</i>           | 2024        |

## CORE QUALIFICATIONS

- Advanced Programming Skills: Python, Java, JavaScript, SQL, R
- Website Design, Development and Backend Maintenance
- Data and Information Analysis and Management
- Analysis, Design and Optimize Computer Algorithms
- Analysis, Evaluate and Reengineer Business Processes
- Design, Develop and Manage Projects in Practice
- Experienced with Key Development and Design Methodologies

## PROFESSIONAL RELEVANT SKILLS

- Working in High Performing Team
- Communication and Presentation
- Time Management and Multitasking
- Adaptability and Flexibility
- Relationship Building and Management
- Critical Thinking and Problem-Solving

## LANGUAGES

- **English**  
Professional Working Proficiency
- **Chinese, Mandarin**  
Native

## ACADEMIC REFERENCES

- Anusha Withana  
([anusha.withana@sydney.edu.au](mailto:anusha.withana@sydney.edu.au))
- Craig Jin  
([craig.jin@sydney.edu.au](mailto:craig.jin@sydney.edu.au))
- Howe Zhu  
([howe.zhu@sydney.edu.au](mailto:howe.zhu@sydney.edu.au))
- Zhanna Sarsenbayeva  
([zhanna.sarsenbayeva@sydney.edu.au](mailto:zhanna.sarsenbayeva@sydney.edu.au))